

Open Government Data Platform Help

OGD Overview, Roles and Responsibilities of Chief Data Officers (CDOs), Publishing of Catalog & Resources

Open Government Data (OGD) Platform India

The policy envisages the proactive dissemination of Government resources e.g. datasets, apps, tools etc. through the Open Government Data (OGD) Platform India – data.gov.in - to foster innovation; improve delivery of government information & services besides promoting transparency, accountability and public participation in governance. The datasets released on the Data Portal India get added advantage through visualization, enhanced discoverability & usage. By making data available in machine-readable formats, the OGD Platform also facilitates collaboration and cooperation between government and the public.

Publishing & Management Of Catalogs And Resources

Role Of Chief Data Officer

The Chief Data Officer spearheads the implementation of NDSAP in his/her Ministry/Department/ Organization. The key responsibilities of the Chief Data Officer are

- Take initiative to release as many datasets as possible on proactive basis.
- Identify the High Value Datasets and schedule their release on Open Government Data Platform India.
- Nominate Data Contributors.
- Ensure that the datasets being published are in compliance with NDSAP through a predefined workflow process.
- Periodically monitor the release of datasets as per predefined schedule.
- Take relevant action on the feedback/suggestions received from the citizen for the datasets belonging to the Ministry/Department/Organization.
- Head the NDSAP Cell, which helps in compilation, collation, conversion and publishing catalogs/resource on the platform. The size of the cell varies from Department to Department and depends on the quantum of resources to be published.

Role Of Data Contributor

A Chief Data Officer is empowered to nominate a number of Data Contributors who would be responsible for ensuring quality and correctness datasets of his/her unit/division and contributing catalogs and resources along with the metadata on the OGD Platform.

Contribution, Approval And Publishing Process For Catalogs And Resources

Chief Data Officer (CDO) can Log In into the OGD Platform using his/her EMAIL ID provided in the DC nomination letter sent to NIC. You can view the details of nominated Chief Data Officers and corresponding nomination letters on the OGD platform for your Ministry/Department/ Organization at <http://data.gov.in/datacontrollers>

Nominate Data Contributors. They can be Directors or Heads of respective divisions/units. They will coordinate, identify, prepare and release datasets of their division/unit OGD Platform. Data Contributors will try to prepare list of datasets which can be contributed. Prepare and contribute the metadata in predefined format for the datasets. The key metadata elements are Title, Description, Sector/Sub-Sector, Dataset Jurisdiction, Keywords, Access Method, Reference URLs, Data Group Name, Frequency and Policy Compliance. Detail about metadata elements and process to create Catalog/Resources is available at <https://data.gov.in/help-dms> after login.

Catalogs/Resources along with the metadata contributed by the Data Contributor pass through a predefined workflow to the Chief Data Officer; who in turn ensures that it is in compliance with the NDSAP Policy. Catalogs/Resources are published only after approval of Chief Data Officer.

Chief Data Officer can edit the catalog/resources or can send it back to the Data Contributor for review/modification or pushes those to NDSAP PMU for publishing on the OGD Platform. The NDSAP PMU at NIC headquarters pushes the catalogs/resources from staging area to the production area and publishes on OGD Platform.

Ministry/Department should organize a workshop on OGD Platform for Chief Data Officer, Contributors and technical team for 2 hours that would help the stakeholders to understand the process better. NDSAP PMU would impart requisite training during the session about how to proceed and optimally make use of the platform for uploading Catalogs/Resources.

Detailed step by step procedures for resources (dataset/apps) contribution are available at <https://data.gov.in/help-dms> after login. The Open Data Implementation Guidelines are available on the homepage of the OGD Platform at <https://data.gov.in/sites/default/files/NDSAP%20Implementation%20Guidelines%202.4.pdf>.

For further details regarding implementation of NDSAP in your Ministry/Department you may contact:

NDSAP PMU (Programme Management Unit)
National Informatics Centre, DeitY
Room No. 375, 3rd Floor, A4B4 bay
A Block, CGO Complex, Lodi Road New Delhi - 110003
Phone: 011-24305381, 011-24305940
Email: ndsap [at] gov [dot] in

Open Government Data Platform India - DON'Ts

Don't contribute datasets which fall under the negative List e.g. the datasets which are confidential in nature and are in the interest of the country's security.

Don't impose 'Terms of Service', attribution requirements, restrictions on dissemination and so on, which act as barriers to public use of data.

Don't impose cost on the public for access of datasets, as imposing fees for access skews the pool of who is willing (or able) to access information.

Don't publish hand written note, as it is very difficult for machines to process. Scanning text via Optical Character Recognition (OCR) results in many matching and formatting errors. Information shared in the widely used PDF format is very difficult for machines to parse. Hence, the data in these formats should be avoided.

Data in non-Unicode formats should be avoided.

Don't contribute datasets with any special characters (e.g. @, %, \$, &, etc.) or missing values.

Don't provide any explanation, including the method of calculation or source of data in data file to be attached in the web form.

Open Government Data Platform India - DO's

Identify and prioritize the release of datasets; categorize the type of access granted for them and publish as many high value datasets as possible.

Contribute datasets which are in the Open List and do not fall under the Negative List.

Ensure that the quality standards are met i.e. accuracy, free from any sort of legal issues, privacy of an individual is maintained and does not compromise with the National security.

Ensure that the datasets being published through a workflow process are in compliance with NDSAP. Details on original source of the dataset and methodology of the data collection should be provided in metadata.

Prepare and contribute the metadata in predefined format for the Catalogs and Resources (Datasets/Apps). The key metadata elements are Title, Description, Category, Sector/Sub-Sector, Dataset Jurisdiction, Keywords, Access Method, Reference URLs, Data Group Name, Frequency, Granularity of Data and Policy Compliance. All the metadata elements must be filled with utmost quality and ease of use.

Pricing of data, if any, would be decided by the data owners as per the government policies.

Ensure that data being contributed to the OGD Platform are in machine readable or in specified open data format only. The advisable formats are:

- CSV (Comma separated Values)
 - XLS (spread sheet- Excel)
 - ODS (Open Document Formats for Spreadsheets)
 - XML (Extensive Markup Language)
 - RDF (Resources Description Framework)
 - KML (Keyhole Markup Language used for Maps)
 - GML (Geography Markup Language)
 - RSS/ATOM (Fast changing data e.g. hourly/daily)
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(Tim Berners-Lee had classified data into single star to five star categories based on formats for the data. Please refer to Annexure II in the Implementation Guidelines)

Ensure that the data being uploaded on the OGD Platform is as complete as possible, reflecting the entirety of what is recorded about a particular subject and is de-normalized. The datasets also should be optimized by adding redundant data or by grouping data before uploading

Priority should be given to data whose utility is time sensitive. Real time information updates would maximize the utility the public can obtain from this information.

Replace any Not Available, Not Reported or missing values in the data with 'NA'.

Metadata that defines and explains the raw data should be included as well, along with formulas and explanations for how derived data was calculated.

Keywords must be defined in data catalog to make it search friendly.

Provide link to the reference documents (if any) or website for detailed information and explanation on the method of calculation or source of data.

Read the process manual at <https://data.gov.in/help> for the step by step procedure for contribution.

Prioritize the release of datasets and take relevant action on the basis of feedbacks and suggestions received on the OGD Platform from citizen's pertaining to the Ministry/Department.

Ensure the correctness of login details on the OGD Platform by sending a mail to ndsap [at] gov [dot] in, in case of any change.

Services available for Chief Data Officers and Data Contributors

Comprehensive details regarding services and features can be accessed by Chief Data Officers and Data Contributors by navigating to the 'Help' link within the [dashboard](#).

Services available for registered portal users

The Open Government Data Platform India - data.gov.in - provides following additional features to the registered portal users:

- To post blogs
- To contribute community apps
- To create forum topic
- To submit request for API
- Suggest/Endorse Datasets
- Comment on Blogs and Forum

- Visitors Dashboard - To see their Suggested datasets, Blog, Forum topic, Community Application on their respective dashboards
- API Key generation and access of API URLs using API Key

To avail the facilities, first click the Login button on the top right corner of the page. Enter the username/email and password. Click on login button to login into the portal.

Screen Reader Access

Open Government Data (OGD) Platform India - data.gov.in fully complies with [Guidelines for Indian Government Websites](#).

Our visitors with visual impairments can access the Portal using Assistive Technologies, such as screen readers.

The information of the Portal is accessible with different screen readers, such as JAWS, NVDA, SAFA, Supernova and Window-Eyes.

Following table lists the information about different screen readers:

Screen Access For All (SAFA)	http://safo-reader.software.informer.com/2.0	Free
Non Visual Desktop Access (NVDA)	http://www.nvda-project.org/	Free
System Access To Go	http://www.satogo.com/	Free
Thunder	https://www.webbie.org.uk/thunder/	Free
WebAnywhere	http://webinsight.cs.washington.edu/	Free
Hal	http://www.yourdolphin.co.uk/productdetail.asp?id=5	Commercial
JAWS	http://www.freedomscientific.com/Downloads/JAWS	Commercial
Supernova	http://www.yourdolphin.co.uk/productdetail.asp?id=1	Commercial